

Principal's Message – The Children's House Montessori Kindergarten Bahrain

Dear Parents and Guardians,

Assalamu Alaikum and a very warm welcome to The Children's House Montessori Kindergarten.

My name is Ms. Aneesa Tabassam, and I have the profound privilege of serving as your Principal. When I walk through our doors each morning, I do so with a heart full of gratitude—for the children who fill our classrooms with curiosity, for the parents who trust us with their most precious gifts, and for the legacy of excellence that has lived here since 1997.

My Unconventional Journey to Montessori

You may wonder what brings a chemical engineer to the world of early childhood education. It is a question I love answering.

In 2018, I graduated from the University of Bahrain with a degree in Chemical Engineering. I spent years teaching chemistry to IGCSE, IB, and A-Level students—watching bright young minds grapple with complex concepts. And yet, time and again, I noticed something. The students who truly excelled were not simply the most intelligent. They were the ones who had learned *how to learn*. They were curious. They were independent. They were not afraid to make mistakes and try again.

I began searching for the roots of these qualities. And I found them here—in the Montessori method.

That discovery changed everything for me. I went on to complete my Bachelor of Education, a Professional Development Course for Teachers from UOB, and most importantly, my Montessori Diploma. I wanted to understand not just *what* children learn, but *how* they learn at the very beginning of their journey.

What This Means for Your Child

My background in engineering and chemistry is not separate from my role as a Montessori principal—it is essential to it. Maria Montessori was, after all, a scientist herself. She observed children with the same precision that an engineer applies to a

complex system. She understood that every material, every activity, every interaction in the prepared environment serves a purpose.

At The Children's House, nothing is left to chance. Every Montessori material on our shelves has been carefully designed to develop specific skills: concentration, coordination, order, and independence. Our guides observe your children not to judge them, but to understand them—so that each child receives exactly what they need, exactly when they are ready.

This is not magic. It is science. And it is my greatest joy to lead a school where science meets wonder every single day.

The Promise of Our School

As the first Montessori nursery school in Bahrain, established in 1997, and proudly accredited by the Montessori Evaluation and Accreditation Board (MEAB), we carry a responsibility to honour the past while embracing the future.

Our promise to you is simple:

- **Authentic Montessori practice** – Not "Montessori-inspired." Not "Montessori-based." Authentic, MEAB-accredited Montessori education.
- **A prepared environment** – Beautiful, orderly, child-sized classrooms where every object has a purpose and a place
- **Qualified, compassionate guides** – Teachers trained to observe, respect, and nurture
- **A community of belonging** – Where your child is known, valued, and loved

An Open Door

Maria Montessori wrote, "The child is both a hope and a promise for mankind". I believe this with my whole heart.

You will find me in our classrooms, observing our children at work. You will find me at the gate in the morning, ready to listen. You will find me available to you—because a school is not a building. It is a partnership between educators and families.

I invite you to visit us. Watch your child choose a work. Watch them concentrate. Watch them smile with the quiet satisfaction of having done it themselves. And then you will understand why I left engineering for Montessori.

With warmth and respect,

Ms. Aneesa Tabassam

Principal

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